MILITARY SPECIFICATION

DRAPE, SURGICAL, NONWOVEN FABRIC, GREEN, DISPOSABLE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers sterile, disposable drapes, of one size, for use in surgical operating rooms of military medical treatment facilities.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect, on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification, to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard.

Military

MIL-S-36585	Sterilization Test Strip Set, Bacterial Spore.

STANDARDS

Federal

Fed. Test Method STD No. 191	Textile Test Methods.

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

FSC 6530

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(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

U. S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION PUBLICATION:
Pharmacopeia of the United States.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, Pa.)

TECHNICAL MANUAL OF THE AMERICAN
ASSOCIATION OF TEXTILE CHEMISTS AND COLORISTS
Volume 48, 1972

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists, P. O. Box 12215, Research Triangle Park, N.C. 27709.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Nonwoven fabric. The nonwoven fabric shall be manufactured from cellulosic or synthetic fiber or a combination thereof, and may be wet or dry formed, or scrim, or fiber reinforced at the manufacturer's option. The nonwoven fabric shall be bonded and water repellent treated and shall not separate in normal handling and use. It shall have no known irritating or toxic elements, lint or objectionable noises or odors. The finished and treated fabric shall be abrasion resistant and have good drape, and shall conform to the requirements specified in Table I.

Table I. Requirements Before Sterilization

Characteristic	Requirement
Breaking strength - lbs., min.	
Machine direction	10
Cross direction	8
Hand of Fabric (Softness) - grams, max.	
Machine direction	35
Cross direction	35
Dry Abrasion Resistance, 2.5 lb. Load-cycles, min.	
End-point pilling	10
End-point failure (destruction)	25
or Weight loss - percent, max.	10
Flame Resistance - sec., min.	3.5
Surface Resistivity, 50% R. H. - ohms/sq., max.	1×10^{11}
Water Repellency - minutes, min.	20
or	
Spray Rating - min.	70, 70, 70
Weight-oz./sq. yd., min.	1.5

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3.2 Outerwrap. The nonwoven fabric shall be manufactured from cellulosic or synthetic fiber or a combination thereof; and may be wet or dry formed, or scrim, or fiber reinforced at the manufacturer's option. The nonwoven fabric shall be resin bonded and shall conform to the requirements specified in Table II.

Table II - Requirements Before Sterilization

Characteristic	Requirement
Breaking strength - lbs., min.	
Machine direction	4.5
Cross direction	1.5
Weight - oz./sq. yd., min.	1.0
Surface Resistivity, 50% R.H.-ohms/sq., max.	1×10^{11}

3.3 Color. The color of the drape shall be misty-green, blue-green, gray-green, on one or both faces. The outerwrap shall be white. Aseptic surfaces shall be glare-free.

3.4 Dimensions. The finished drape shall be 44 ± 2 inches in width and 60 ± 2 inches in length. The outerwrap dimensions shall be adequate to maintain sterility.

3.5 Sterility. The drape pack in its immediate container shall be sterile when tested with a biological indicator as specified in 4.3.

3.5.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that samples from each sterilizer lot have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include:

a. Item Identification.
b. National stock number.
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number.
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Quantity of product in sterilizer lot.
g. Type of sterilization (gas, radiation, heat, steam, etc.).

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h. Form of biological indicator (i. e., inoculated paper spore strip or carrier, inoculated product, or inoculated simulated product).
i. Test organism(s) and population density used.
j. Test medium, incubation temperature, incubation time, and dates of tests.
k. Number of test units.
l. Statement that samples comply with sterility tests.
m. Signature of head of laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.

When inspection is made at destination, the certificate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the Directorate of Medical Materiel, ATTN: DPSC-ATQ, Defense Personnel Support Center, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, Pa., 19101, and a copy forwarded with each shipment to the consignee. When inspection is made at source, certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant Government Quality Assurance Representative for submission to the procuring activity.

3.5.2 Sterility lot. A sterility lot is that single quantity of product subjected to the same manufacturing operation and simultaneously sterilized in the same sterilizer chamber. Each unit package shall be clearly marked with a sterility lot (control) number and date of sterilization as specified in 5.3.1. Each sterility lot shall be traceable to the pertinent manufacturing lot(s).

3.6 Folding. The drape and outerwrap shall be functionally folded for optimum aseptic techniques.

3.7 Marking. The folded drape shall be clearly marked "Drape" or "Drape Sheet". The marking shall be sterilizable.

3.8 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The drape packs shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available for review to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory) investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the components listed in 3.1, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the FSN, the item identification, the name of the component or material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements. Where certificates of quality are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Visual examination of the pack. Defects found during this examination shall be classified in accordance with table III. The sample unit for this examination shall be one pack.

4.2.1 Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels shall be as shown in table III. The sample unit for examination shall be one pack.

TABLE III

	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major Defects	S-3	2.5
Minor Defects	S-3	4.0

4.2.2 Classification of defects (pack). The pack shall be visually examined for the defects listed in table IV.

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TABLE IV. Classification of defects

Major	
101	Any component missing or other than specified.
102	Components not functionally folded.
103	Marking not free of bleeding into material.
104	Marking omitted, incorrect, illegible.
105	Any component not free of holes and tears.
106	Any component not clean, not free from foreign material.
Minor	
201	Outer wrap torn or ripped.
202	Drape not proper length and width.
203	Unit marking not complete, illegible.

4.3 Sterility test. The drape pack shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the USP for purified cotton, gauze, surgical dressings and related material using inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). Product containing a biological indicator shall be marked or labeled so that it clearly differentiates from product intended for distribution. The incubation medium and minimum time in each case shall be soybean casein digest for 7 days for inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). The incubation temperature shall be as indicated in paragraph 4.3.1. The minimum number of test units, regardless of lot size, shall be 10, except for inoculated carrier which shall be 20 for Type I Sterilization and 30 for Type II Sterilization including inoculated carrier and product test units.

4.3.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. For each type of sterilization, the organism used shall be as listed below:

Type of Sterilization	Organism	Incubation Temperature
Steam	B. stearothermophilus	55° - 65°C
Dry Heat	B. stearothermophilus, or	55° - 65°C
	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Gas	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Radiation	B. pumilus	30° - 35°C

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The number of viable cells shall be sufficient to provide assurance that the product has been sterilized.

4.3.2 Inoculated carrier. Inoculated carriers (paper spore strips) if used shall be in accordance with MIL-S-36586. Other paper carriers shall be inoculated to be of equivalent resistance. The method of incubation and number of test units shall be as indicated in 4.3 Sterility test; and 4.3.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. The method of sterilization will control the organism in the spore strip to be tested for as shown in 4.3.1. NOTE: When an inoculated carrier is chosen, product samples must also be tested as required by the USP.

4.3.3 Alternate method. Suppliers conducting sterility tests or designating lots in a manner other than that indicated herein shall submit proof that the alternate method provides equal assurance concerning the sterility of the product. However, all sterility tests shall be conducted using biological indicators. Requests for approval of any alternate method of testing for sterility shall be made to the Contracting Officer, and approval obtained before employment of the alternate method on a government contract.

4.3.4 Product testing. Testing for sterility of the product after receipt by the government shall be without a biological indicator and in accordance with the USP.

4.4 Testing of the drape and outerwrap fabric-physical requirements. The methods of testing specified in Fed. Std. No. 191, wherever applicable, and as listed in table V shall be followed. Except as otherwise indicated, the physical and chemical values specified in section 3 apply to the average of the determinations made on a sample unit for test purposes as specified in the applicable test methods. The sample unit shall be 2 continuous yards, full width, of the finished fabric. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more sample units fail to meet any test requirements.

Table V. Test Methods

Characteristic	Test Method
Breaking strength	5100
Flame resistance	5908 1/
Surface resistivity	76-1972-AATCC 2/
Abrasion resistance	par. 4.4.2
Abrasion resistance	93-1970-AATCC 3/
Water repellency	par. 4.4.3
Spray rating	5526
Weight	par. 4.4.4 or 5041
Hand of fabric	par. 4.4.1

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1/ Burning rate-45 degree angle.
2/ 50 percent relative humidity.
3/ Run for 20 sec. at 3000 rpm.

4.4.1 Hand of fabric.

This method is applicable to the determination of the hand of non-woven fabrics in the weight of 1.0 - 4.0 oz./sq. yd..

Principle of Method. The prepared specimen is placed on a slotted plate and the force required to push it through a slot of known width is recorded. This force can be related to the surface friction and flexual resistance of the specimen under test.

Conditioning. Samples shall be conditioned for at least 2 hours at a relative humidity of 65% ± 2% at 70° F. ± 2°F..

Apparatus. Model 211-5 Handle-O-Meter.

STANDARDIZATION:

a. Set the slot width to 10 mm. unless otherwise specified.

b. Standardize the instrument in accordance with the manufacturer's calibration procedure.

SAMPLE PREPARATION:

a. Cut sample 4" x 4" square (unless otherwise specified) taking care to ensure the edges are parallel or perpendicular to the machine direction. Five samples shall be taken randomly across the width of the material with the machine direction identified. (NOTE: Crease free areas of fabric should be selected, and care exercised to ensure that all edges are parallel or perpendicular to the machine direction.)

PROCEDURE:

a. Place the sample on the plate with the direction that is being tested perpendicular to the slot. The sample should extend across the slot with the far edge parallel to the beam and exactly three inches from the edge of the slot.

b. Actuate the penetration beam and record maximum reading.

c. The sample is rotated 90 degrees and a second reading taken which expresses hand in the opposite direction of the fabric.

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d. The sample is turned over and readings are taken of the other 2 ends which gives a total of 2 MD and 2 CD readings per 4" x 4" square.

e. Five specimens shall be tested giving a total of ten readings in the MD and ten in the CD.

CALCULATIONS:

The hand of the sample in each direction shall be the average of the ten readings and shall be reported to the nearest gram.

4.4.2 Abrasion Resistance.

This method is applicable to determining the abrasion resistance of a reinforced disposable fabric.

Principle of Method. A sample is abraded with Lytron 80 x 56 finished cloth and the resultant damage noted.

Apparatus. Stoll Quartermaster Abrasion Tester with Frosting Method Attachment, High intensity light, Magnifying glass.

Material. 80 x 56 Lytron finished cloth.

SAMPLE PREPARATION:

a. Cut strips of Lytron finished cloth 3" wide x 10" long, with the long dimension in the warp direction, to be used as the abradant.

b. Cut 5" squares of the material to be tested.

PROCEDURE:

a. Secure the abradant to the face of the top plate. Fresh abradant is used for each sample.

b. Fasten the test sample on the foam pad of the bottom plate.

c. Place a 2-1/2 lb. weight on the top plate.

d. Focus the high intensity lamp on the sample.

e. Set the counter at zero, lower the top face until the abradant is in contact with the sample, and turn on the tester.

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f. Inspect the sample every 5 cycles from 5-20 cycles, and every 10 cycles from 20 until failure. If failure has not occurred at 100 cycles the test may be terminated.

CONCLUSIONS:

Results are reported at two different stages of the test:

a. The number of cycles when pilling is first noted. Pilling is defined as the breaking off of fibers which start to form clumps or beads.

b. The number of cycles necessary for a hole to start to appear in the top surface of the test material.

4.4.3 Water Repellency. This procedure is applicable to the determination of the repellency of a yarn reinforced disposable fabric.

Principle of Method		The fabric to be tested is used to seal an inverted vented mason jar containing a saline solution and the penetration of the solution through the fabric noted.
Apparatus	a.	2-11/16 inch diameter circular cutting die.
	b.	Mason jars (1 qt.) with holes drilled in the bottom and metal rings with openings 2-3/16 inch in diameter and fitted with gaskets. Gasket size is outside diameter 2-3/4 inch, inside diameter 2-3/16 inch. The gaskets are to be cut from a coated fabric No. ES-555-13.
	c.	One glass plate.
	d.	One mirror.
	e.	A lamp to place between glass and mirror to shine on sample during test. (Tensor high intensity lamp).
Reagents		0.9% Saline Solution.

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Sample Preparation	Die cut 5 samples randomly across the width of the fabric or cut 5 - 5 inch squares randomly across the width of the fabric.
Procedure	a. Hold a finger on the vent hole, pour enough saline solution into a jar to give a 4-1/2 inch head (approx. 600 mls.).
	b. Place the test sample on the mouth of the jar and screw the metal ring with gasket in place with sufficient torque to prevent leakage.
	c. Invert the jar onto the glass plate which is mounted six to eight inches above the mirror.
	d. Start the timing of the test as soon as the jar is inverted onto the glass plate and terminate it at the first sign of penetration. Penetration is evidenced when saline penetrates the fabric and wets the glass plate. Occasionally some condensation (a light "fog") will be observed on the surface of the glass and care must be taken that this is not confused with a testing failure.

4.4.4 Weight per square yard. This method is applicable to the determination of weight per square yard of a reinforced disposable fabric.

Principle of Method	Samples are to be conditioned. After conditioning, an accurately measured sample is weighed and weight per square yard calculated.
Conditioning	Samples shall be conditioned for at least four hours at a relative humidity of 65% ± 2%, at 70° ± 2°F..
Accuracy	Approximately 1% of the true value.
Apparatus	Balance weighing accurately to 0.01 grams or 1 grain.
	Scissors.
	Steel Rule, graduated in 1/32 inch.

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Procedure

Lay the fabric on a smooth horizontal surface and draw a line across the full width perpendicular to the edge. Draw another line parallel to the first line and at such a distance from the first line that approximately 2/3 of a square yard (864 sq. in.) in area of sample is defined. Cut out the area laid out above and weigh.

Calculations

$$W = \frac{W_e \times 1296}{L \times I}$$

or

$$= \frac{W_m \times 1296 \times 15.43}{L \times I}$$

W = Weight, grains per square yard.
W_e = Weight of specimen, grains.
W_m = Weight of specimen, grams.
I = Width of specimen in inches.
L = Length of specimen in inches.
15.43 - grains/gram.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be Level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One package, containing 24 drapes, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Packaging quantities. The number of units of issue indicated in Table IV shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate, and exterior container, as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in the procurement document.

Table IV Packaging Quantities

Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior container
1 unit	Not applicable	2 units

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5.1.2.1 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units in the entire shipment is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units may be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which shall insure safe delivery to destination.

5.1.3 Level A.

5.1.3.1 Individual package. Each functionally folded drape wrapped in the non-woven fabric overwrap shall be enclosed in a heat sealed, sterilizable, tamperproof, paper or plastic bag. The bag shall be capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless damaged or opened. The bag shall be provided with a tear string, tear tape, or tabs or other suitable means to facilitate opening. Plastic bags shall have a minimum thickness of 0.002 inches.

5.1.3.2 Protective bag. When the individual package is paper, it shall be further inserted into a plastic bag having a minimum wall thickness of 0.002 inches. Closure shall be adequate to prevent spilling of contents under normal handling.

5.1.3.3 Unit package. Twenty-four individually packaged drapes shall be packaged in a snug fitting box constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, Class domestic. Closure shall conform to method I as specified in PPP-B-636.

5.1.4 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-601, overseas type or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grade V3c. Special requirements specified in Table II of PPP-B-636 shall apply for fiberboard boxes. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.1.2 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Fiberboard boxes shall be waterproofed in accordance with 30.4 of PPP-B-636.

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NOTE: Strapping shall not be required for shipments forwarded to a receiving activity within the continental limits of the United States for storage and redistribution.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-601, domestic type, or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Fiberboard box shall be closed by method II as specified in PPP-B-636. In addition, fiberboard boxes shall conform to the special requirements as specified in Table I of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Individual package.

5.3.1.1 Paper bag. In addition to any commercial markings, each paper or plastic bag shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. In addition marking shall include the name of contractor and the legend: "STERILE" AND "STERILITY GUARANTEED UNLESS PACKAGE IS DAMAGED OR OPENED". In addition, plastic bags shall also be marked with the legend: "CAUTION: PLASTIC BAG SHALL BE REMOVED PRIOR TO USE IN HAZARDOUS ATMOSPHERE".

The caution statement shall not be required when antistatic bag are utilized. However, when antistatic bags are utilized, they shall be marked with the legend 'ANTI-STATIC'."

5.3.1.2 Plastic bag. Each protective bag shall be marked with the applicable anti-static or caution legend as specified in 5.3.1.1.

5.3.2 Unit package. Each unit package shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129. Marking shall include the sterility lot (control) number. The method of sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, S-Steam, C-Cold, D-Dry Heat sterilization) shall be shown following the level packaging and date of packaging. Example: "A-7/73-G". Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date.

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5.3.3 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. The sterility lot (control) number and the method of sterilization as specified in 5.3.2 shall also be shown.

6. NOTES.

6.1 Intended use. The drapes covered by this specification are for use in surgical operating rooms of military medical treatment facilities.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 This specification is intended to cover the following item appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock No.	Item Identification
6530-00-118-0670	DRAPE, SURGICAL: Nonwoven Fabric, Green, Disposable, 44 by 60 inches, 24s.

6.4 This specification does not include all types, classes, grades, or sizes, of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types which are normally procured to meet military requirements.

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:

Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project Number: 6530-1284

Review information is current as of the date of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on the information in the current DODISS.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: The purpose of this form is to solicit beneficial comments which will help achieve procurement of suitable products at reasonable cost and minimum delay, or will otherwise enhance use of the document. DoD contractors, government activities, or manufacturers/vendors who are prospective suppliers of the product are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

   ☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

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